Curriculum Vitae – Yican Liu

Ph.D. Candidate in Finance

Department of Finance
HKU Business School

yicanliu@connect.hku.hk
www.yicanliu.com

Referees

Professor Fangzhou Lu *(Co-Chair)*
University of Hong Kong
lufz@hku.hk

Professor Yiming Cao *(Co-Chair)*
University of Hong Kong
ymcao@hku.hk

Professor Tse-Chun Lin
University of Hong Kong
tsechunlin@hku.hk

Professor Mingzhu Tai
University of Hong Kong
taimzh@hku.hk

Education

2022- University of Hong Kong
Ph.D., Finance

2020-2022 Duke University
M.A., Economics, *with Honor*

2015-2019 Renmin University of China
B.A., Finance

Research

Research Interests

Primary fields: Financial technology; Digital economy; Economics of artificial intelligence.
Secondary fields: Development economics; Experimental economics

Under Revision / Conditionally Accepted

2026 How Valuable are Consumers' Digital Footprints?
Tingyu Feng, Yican Liu, Fangzhou Lu
Revise and Resubmit, **Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis**

2025 AI Exposure and Policy Preferences: Experimental Evidence from Latin America
Yiming Cao, Tian Chen, Yican Liu, Guillermo Rosas
Conditionally Accepted via Pre-Results Review, **Journal of Development Economics**
Randomized Experiment in Progress (Planned Resubmission Date: 2027)

Working Papers

2026 Crypto ATMs: Material Effects of Virtual Currencies
Lin William Cong, Tingyu Feng, Yican Liu, Fangzhou Lu

2026 The Environmental Cost of AI Development
Zongyuan Deng, Yican Liu, Fan Zhang

2026 Happy App Happy Tip: The Return Predictability from Amusement Apps Downloads Around the World
Tse-Chun Lin, Yican Liu, Fangzhou Lu

Works in Progress

2026 AI-Writings, *joint with Zongyuan Deng and Yuheng Wang*
2026 The Politics of Cross-Sectional Stock Return of A-Shares, *joint with Fangzhou Lu and Hanyu Zheng*
2025 Scientific Research in the Media, *joint with Yiming Cao, Tian Chen, and Guillermo Rosas*
2022 Economic Consequences of Historical Conflicts, *joint with Tian Chen, Pei Gao, and Yu-Hsiang Lei*

Grants for Academic Research

2024-2025 OpenAI Researcher Access Program, *OpenAI*
10,000 USD, *joint with Yiming Cao, Tian Chen, Guillermo Rosas*

2023-2026 Graduate Student Grant for Business Research, *HKU Business School, University of Hong Kong*
45,000 HKD

Awards, Fellowships, and Honors

2022-2026 HKU Presidential Ph.D. Scholarship, *University of Hong Kong*
2022-2025 Hong Kong Ph.D. Fellowship Scheme, *Research Grants Council of Hong Kong*
2022 Ph.D. Student Entrance Scholarship, *HKU Business School, University of Hong Kong*
2022 Award for Academic Excellence for Graduate Students, *Department of Economics, Duke University*
2020, 2021 M.A. Merit Scholar Award, *Department of Economics, Duke University*
2016, 2017 Merit Student of Renmin University of China, *School of Finance, Renmin University of China*

Professional Experiences

Presentation

2026 Chinese Finance Annual Meeting; University of Nottingham Ningbo China (Department of Economics); HKU Finance Brownbag; CES China Annual Conference; Shanghai University of Finance and Economics (Dishui Lake Annual Conference)
2025 HKU Finance Brownbag; HKU Economics (Development Seminar); Lingnan-Jinan Joint Conference on Sustainable Finance; Renmin University of China (Renmin Business School)
2023 HKU Finance Brownbag; HKU Economics

Conference and Seminar Organization

2026 The Economics of Technological Change, *organizing committee, joint with Timm Betz, Yiming Cao, Tian Chen, and Guillermo Rosas (scheduled, at Washington University in St. Louis and Rice University)*